At Seymour Johnson Air Force Base, we authorized $54 million for the child development center. During multiple base visits, we toured the existing center, which is in dire need of repair, met with staff, and visited the precious children of our servicemembers, who are in dire need of this support.

We also authorized $41 million for Seymour Johnson's Combat Arms Training and Maintenance Complex to ensure our airmen are ready to deploy.

Additionally, we authorized a timeline extension for the Marine Corps Air Station Cherry Point Flightline Utilities Modernization project in full support of our F–35s.

Our investments here in eastern North Carolina will not only strengthen our economy but also contribute to America's safety.

RECOGNIZING POLICE CHIEF DENTON CARLSON

(Mr. DESAULNIER asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. DESAULNIER. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize the extraordinary career of San Ramon, California, Police Chief Denton Carlson as he retires after 27 years of service.

Chief Carlson began his law enforcement career in 1998 and later joined the San Ramon Police Department during its founding in 2007. Quickly rising through the ranks, he became captain in 2017 and chief in 2022.

Chief Carlson additionally served as the director of the city's Office of Emergency Management from 2015 to 2022. His leadership was instrumental in launching the police department's community resource and crime prevention division and its social media and emergency communications systems.

Deeply respected in the community by all the citizens, please join me in thanking Chief Carlson for his extraordinary and many years of public service and for public safety and congratulating him on a well-deserved retirement.

MESSAGE FROM THE SENATE

A message from the Senate by Ms. Lasky, one of its clerks, announced that the Senate has passed bills of the following titles in which the concurrence of the House is requested:

S. 1884. An act to clarify the Holocaust Expropriated Art Recovery Act of 2016, to appropriately limit the application of defenses based on the passage of time and other nonmerits defenses to claims under that Act.

S. 2584. An act to amend title 18, United States Code, regarding additional assessments on convicted persons, and for other purposes.

S. 3424. An act to amend titles 11 and 28, United States Code, to modify the compensation payable to trustees serving in cases under chapter 7 of title 11, United States Code, to extend the term of certain temporary offices of bankruptcy judges, and for other purposes.

PROMOTING EFFICIENT REVIEW FOR MODERN INFRASTRUCTURE TODAY ACT

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. GRAVES. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on H.R. 3898.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. OWENS). Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Missouri?

There was no objection.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 936 and rule XVIII, the Chair declares the House in the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union for the consideration of the bill, H.R. 3898.

The Chair appoints the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. MCDOWELL) to preside over the Committee of the Whole.

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IN THE COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE

Accordingly, the House resolved itself into the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union for the consideration of the bill (H.R. 3898) to amend the Federal Water Pollution Control Act to make targeted reforms with respect to waters of the United States and other matters, and for other purposes, with Mr. MCDOWELL in the chair.

The CHAIR. The House is in the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union for the consideration of H.R. 3898, which the Clerk will report by title.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The CHAIR. Pursuant to the rule, the bill is considered read the first time.

General debate shall be confined to the bill and amendments specified in section 1 of House Resolution 936 and shall not exceed 1 hour equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure or their respective designees.

The gentleman from Missouri (Mr. GRAVES) and the gentlewoman from Michigan (Ms. SCHOLTEN) each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Missouri.

Mr. GRAVES. Mr. Chairman, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Chair, I am proud to rise in support of H.R. 3898, the Promoting Efficient Review for Modern Infrastructure Today Act, or the PERMIT Act, which will make permitting processes under the Clean Water Act more efficient, consistent, and transparent while continuing to protect our Nation's water quality.

Our Clean Water Act permitting regime is broken.

When it takes up to 18 months to receive a permit under just the Clean Water Act to build a pipeline, dam, road, pond, or home, something is simply wrong.

When wastewater utilities are being sued by radical environmentalists because the EPA didn't give them a permit they could trust, something is wrong.

When one State can weaponize the Clean Water Act to stop a pipeline that would allow citizens in other States to move off heating oil in the winter to a cheaper and more reliable source of energy, for reasons not remotely related to water quality, something is wrong.

When the Federal Government is allowed to write water quality standards that no one can afford without passing on costs to the ratepayers, or for which the technology to achieve such standards isn't even available in this country, something is wrong.

I believe that regulations should be simple to understand, achievable, and easy to follow. Good process often leads to good decisionmaking, more consistent outcomes, and prosperity, and that is what this bill seeks to achieve.

The partnership between the private sector, States, and the Federal Government envisioned by the Clean Water Act has worked to improve water quality nationwide. This is a very good thing. We all share the goal of achieving clean water. However, 50 years after its passage, the Clean Water Act needs modernization. It is just as simple as that.

This bill makes commonsense reforms, such as clarifying the section 401 process to stop it from being weaponized; codifying longstanding, bipartisan exemptions from the definition of waters of the United States; placing clear timelines on judicial review for permits; and increasing transparency in the development of water quality standards.

It also directs the Corps to eliminate the backlog of outstanding section 404 permit applications and jurisdictional determinations and eliminate duplicative and unnecessary permitting processes for areas such as pesticides, aerial fire-retardant use, and so much more.

The bottom line is that without reforming the Clean Water Act, America cannot efficiently build roads, bridges, pipelines, ponds, dams, levees, airports, homes, farms, and other infrastructure that we need.

This bill acknowledges that we can both protect our natural resources and allow for development that benefits everyone in this country. Because of this, H.R. 3898 enjoys support from a wide range of stakeholders, from water utilities to energy developers, the construction industry, farmers, and Main Street businesses.

I urge my colleagues who support commonsense solutions to vote in favor of H.R. 3898.

Mr. Chair, I reserve the balance of my time.

Ms. SCHOLTEN. Mr. Chairman, I rise today in opposition to H.R. 3898, the PERMIT Act, but I rise for so much more than just simply to oppose this bill.

The Clean Water Act was enacted into law 50 years ago at a time when